Vova Zakharov

Developer – AI, full-stack, and the bits in-between

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Profile

Developer with a physics-and-math brain, working with LLMs and image generation since 2020, after years of smaller neural networks. I **don't buy or sell buzzwords**, I know **what models can and cannot do**, and I turn vague ideas into working prototypes — or clean up the ones that got vibe-coded into a corner.

What I Offer

- Bring your idea to an MVP/prototype in 1-2 months
- Clean the mess in the prototype you vibe-coded
- Explain exactly why your AI agent doesn't work the way you expected, and fix it

Full profile and offer: vovazakharov.com/cv/dev/en/profile

Experience

Fractional CTO

Playgram (March – August 2026)

Read the case study: vovazakharov.com/case-studies/playgram

Rebuilt a live, feature-rich AI chat product — multiple model providers, realtime team chats, image and file libraries, memory and knowledge management, voice input — from Bubble, a no-code builder, into a production Next.js 16 codebase, while it stayed in production for its users throughout.

Delivered in 158 days — parallel AI sessions, up to 20 agents working at once:

- **1,395 commits on main** and 250,000 lines of TypeScript, tests included, none of it hand-written.
- **48 releases and 18 hotfixes:** a production deploy every 2.4 days.
- **4.5–5× the changes a week per developer** than the app shipped on Bubble before the rebuild.
- **Sub-second cold loads,** down from multi-second.
- **Feature-sliced architecture held by linters,** so a crowd of agents working at once could not drift the structure.
- **A repeatable agent pipeline:** plan, implement, review, finalize — each stage its own session, with a reviewable artifact between them.

`Next.js 16, Supabase + Drizzle, Weaviate, LiteLLM, Railway, feature-sliced design`

Senior Fullstack Developer

October 2025 – February 2026

AI-powered English learning application for kids, combining generative AI with time-tested pedagogical methodology to make language acquisition engaging and effective.

- Interactive game-based learning experiences powered by LLM-generated content.
- Adaptive difficulty and personalized learning paths based on individual progress.
- Integration of proven teaching methods with modern AI capabilities.

`Next.js, OpenAI API, custom game engine`

Senior Fullstack Developer

Orcool (June – August 2025)

Short-term project shaping an AI-agent–based review intelligence tool for brand marketing.

Built the system end-to-end, covering:

- Automated review collection from diverse public sources.
- AI-driven summarization with structured outputs (SWOT, competitive positioning, feature insights).
- Early productization steps toward a scalable SaaS-style platform.

`Next.js/NestJS, Cloudflare Workers, Firebase, custom LLM orchestration framework`

Fullstack Developer

randddb.com / DDB (2023 – 2025)

Experimental AI platform at one of the world's largest ad firms. Built, back to front, a suite of interlinked AI tools:

- **Chatbot:** ChatGPT-style assistant for corporate needs — secure, document-aware, image-savvy, with personas and real-time multi-user support.
- **Robowriter:** Build-your-own-agent tool for content generation. Functions as both user-facing product and meta-backend for LLM ops.
- **Picmaker:** Replicate-powered image generation/training tool with UX optimized for rapid iteration and intuitive pinning.
- **Client-specific apps:** Including YesYouCannes, which builds Cannes award decks from idea to imagery in minutes.
- **Spaces:** White-label mini-platforms for agency clients (e.g. randddb.com/s/ikea).

`Django + DRF, PostgreSQL + pgvector, Redis, Vue + TypeScript`

Demo available on request.

Developer – Independent Projects

2020 – Present

Selected highlights:

- **mitko:** Telegram bot where an LLM matches IT candidates with employers: aiogram, pgvector, PydanticAI.
- **Jukebox Web UI:** Gradio-based UI running inside Google Colab for OpenAI's music model.
- **almostmagic:** TypeScript package for instant LLM integration – one line, zero ceremony.
- **JobGenie:** AI assistant for job seekers that helps create roles as much as apply for them.

Prototyper — Experience & Innovation

Voicemod (2023)

Prototyped bleeding-edge tools for audio + AI experimentation.

- Built a YAML-powered Discord bot framework for zero-code bot creation.
- Developed a local Python web API with a ChatGPT-style interface.

Tech Stack

Languages	TypeScript, Python, SQL
Frontend	Next.js (App Router), React, Mantine, TanStack Query, Zustand, Tiptap; Vue / Nuxt
Backend & data	Next.js server actions / BFF, NestJS, Django, FastAPI, aiogram; Postgres + pgvector, Drizzle, SQLAlchemy, Weaviate, Redis, Django Q2
AI	Vercel AI SDK, PydanticAI, OpenAI / Azure OpenAI / Anthropic / Gemini APIs, LiteLLM, Deepgram, Replicate; Gradio, Google Colab
Infrastructure	Railway, Docker, Cloudflare Workers, GitHub Actions, GitHub Pages, Bunny CDN, Stripe, PostHog
Quality	Vitest, Playwright, MSW, ESLint, Steiger (FSD), knip, Prettier, Stylelint
Agentic engineering	Claude Code, muthur

Education

Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology

Master's in Applied Math & Physics (2000 — 2006)

Contact

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Full portfolio: vovazakharov.com